

- [Skip to main navigation](#)
- [Skip to search](#)
- [Skip to main content](#)

[Coventry University Home](#) [Coventry University Logo](#)

- [Help & FAQ](#)
- [Home](#)
- [Organisational Units](#)
- [Profiles](#)
- [Research output](#)
- [Projects](#)
- [Coventry awarded Student theses](#)
- [Activities](#)
- [Prizes](#)
- [Datasets](#)
- [Press/Media](#)
- [Equipment](#)

Search by expertise, name or affiliation

Developing a Novel Web-Based Self-Management Support Intervention for Polycystic Ovary Syndrome: Mixed Methods Study With Patients and Health Care Professionals

[Carol Percy](#), [Andy Turner](#), Charys Orr

- [School of Psychological, Social and Behavioural Sciences](#)
- [Centre for Intelligent Healthcare](#)
- [Harris Church of England Academy](#)

Research output: Contribution to journal › Article › peer-review

22 Downloads (Pure)

- [Overview](#)
- [Fingerprint](#)

Abstract

Background: Polycystic ovary syndrome (PCOS) represents a significant global health burden requiring urgent attention. This common chronic

endocrine and cardiometabolic condition affects around 1 in 10 women and individuals assigned female at birth, with significant adverse effects on well-being, quality of life, and mental health, as well as serious and complex long-term health consequences. International guidelines for best health care practice recommend the provision of comprehensive cognitive behavioral interventions to support self-management and improve health outcomes for those living with PCOS. Web-based health interventions have the potential to meet this need in an accessible and scalable way.

Objective: We aim to identify barriers to self-management and psychological well-being in women with PCOS and adapt a web-based self-management program to provide a prototype digital support intervention for them.

Methods: We adapted an existing support program (HOPE) for PCOS using the antecedent target measure approach. We conducted qualitative interviews with 13 adult women living with PCOS, 3 trustees of a patients with PCOS advocacy charity, and 4 endocrinologists to identify “antecedents” (barriers) to self-management and psychological well-being. Framework analysis was used to identify potentially modifiable antecedents to be targeted by the novel intervention. At a national conference, 58 key stakeholders (patients and health professionals) voted for the antecedents they felt were most important to address. We used research evidence and relevant theory to design a prototype for the PCOS intervention.

Results: Voting identified 32 potentially modifiable antecedents, relating to knowledge, understanding, emotions, motivation, and behaviors, as priorities to be targeted in the new intervention. A modular, web-based prototype HOPE PCOS intervention was developed to address these, covering six broad topic areas (instilling HOPE for PCOS; managing the stress of PCOS; feeding your mind and body well; body image, intimacy, and close relationships; staying healthy with PCOS; and keeping PCOS in its place).

Conclusions: We identified barriers to self-management and psychological well-being in women with PCOS and used these to adapt a web-based self-management program, tailoring it for PCOS, which is a comprehensive group intervention combining education, empowerment, lifestyle management, peer support with cognitive behavioral tools, and goal-setting (to be delivered by peers or codelivered with health care professionals). The modular structure offers flexibility to adapt the program further as new clinical recommendations emerge. The intervention has the potential to be delivered, evaluated for feasibility, and, if effective, integrated into health care services. Self-management interventions are not designed to replace clinical care; rather, they serve as an additional source of support. The HOPE PCOS program conveys this message in its content and activities. Future research should evaluate the prototype intervention using primary outcomes such as measures of psychological well-being, self-management self-efficacy, depression, anxiety, and PCOS-related quality of life. They should also assess the intervention’s acceptability, scalability, and cost-effectiveness.

Original language English

Article number e52427
Number of pages 22
Journal [JMIR Formative Research](#)
Volume 2024
Issue number 8
Early online date 7 Mar 2024

DOIs • <https://doi.org/10.2196/52427>

Publication status Published - 7 Mar 2024

Bibliographical note

This is an open-access article distributed under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>), which permits unrestricted use, distribution, and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work, first published in JMIR Formative Research, is properly cited. The complete bibliographic information, a link to the original publication on <https://formative.jmir.org>, as well as this copyright and license information must be included.

Funder

The HOPE Program is delivered by Hope for the Community, a community interest company of Coventry University. The intervention development work for this polycystic ovary syndrome intervention was supported by a short-term temporary research sabbatical for CP funded by Coventry University.

Keywords

- anxiety
- depression
- PCOS
- peer support
- polycystic ovary syndrome
- positive well-being
- psychoeducation
- self-management
- web-based health intervention
- women's health

UN SDGs

This output contributes to the following UN [Sustainable Development Goals \(SDGs\)](#)

- SDG 3 - Good Health and Well-being

Access to Document

- [10.2196/52427](#)Licence: [CC BY](#)
- [Percy2024VoR](#)Final published version, 706 KBLicence: [CC BY](#)

Fingerprint

Dive into the research topics of 'Developing a Novel Web-Based Self-Management Support Intervention for Polycystic Ovary Syndrome: Mixed Methods Study With Patients and Health Care Professionals'. Together they form a unique fingerprint.



Patient
Medicine and Dentistry
100%



Polycystic Ovary Syndrome
Medicine and Dentistry
100%



Health Care
Medicine and Dentistry
100%



Mixed Methods
Psychology
100%



Healthcare Professional
Psychology
100%

- 

Polycystic Ovary
Psychology
100%

- 

Self-Management
Psychology
100%

- 

Woman
Medicine and Dentistry
23%

[View full fingerprint](#)

Cite this

- APA
- Standard
- Harvard
- Vancouver
- Author
- BIBTEX
- RIS

Percy, C., Turner, A., & Orr, C. (2024). [Developing a Novel Web-Based Self-Management Support Intervention for Polycystic Ovary Syndrome: Mixed Methods Study With Patients and Health Care Professionals](#). *JMIR Formative Research*, 2024(8), Article e52427. <https://doi.org/10.2196/52427>
[Developing a Novel Web-Based Self-Management Support Intervention for Polycystic Ovary Syndrome: Mixed Methods Study With Patients and Health Care Professionals.](#) / Percy, Carol; Turner, Andy; Orr, Charys.

In: [JMIR Formative Research](#), Vol. 2024, No. 8, e52427, 07.03.2024.

Research output: Contribution to journal › Article › peer-review

[Percy, C, Turner, A & Orr, C 2024, 'Developing a Novel Web-Based Self-Management Support Intervention for Polycystic Ovary Syndrome: Mixed Methods Study With Patients and Health Care Professionals', *JMIR Formative Research*, vol. 2024, no. 8, e52427. <https://doi.org/10.2196/52427>](#)
[Percy C, Turner A, Orr C. Developing a Novel Web-Based Self-Management Support Intervention for Polycystic Ovary Syndrome: Mixed Methods Study](#)

[With Patients and Health Care Professionals. JMIR Formative Research.](#)

2024 Mar 7;2024(8):e52427. Epub 2024 Mar 7. doi: 10.2196/52427

[Percy, Carol ; Turner, Andy ; Orr, Charys. / **Developing a Novel Web-Based Self-Management Support Intervention for Polycystic Ovary Syndrome : Mixed Methods Study With Patients and Health Care Professionals.** In: \[JMIR Formative Research\]\(#\). 2024 ; Vol. 2024, No. 8.](#)

@article{d13ea537c6bd4b7fa29f4bc74abebc1f,

title = "Developing a Novel Web-Based Self-Management Support Intervention for Polycystic Ovary Syndrome: Mixed Methods Study With Patients and Health Care Professionals",

abstract = "Background: Polycystic ovary syndrome (PCOS) represents a significant global health burden requiring urgent attention. This common chronic endocrine and cardiometabolic condition affects around 1 in 10 women and individuals assigned female at birth, with significant adverse effects on well-being, quality of life, and mental health, as well as serious and complex long-term health consequences. International guidelines for best health care practice recommend the provision of comprehensive cognitive behavioral interventions to support self-management and improve health outcomes for those living with PCOS. Web-based health interventions have the potential to meet this need in an accessible and scalable way.Objective: We aim to identify barriers to self-management and psychological well-being in women with PCOS and adapt a web-based self-management program to provide a prototype digital support intervention for them.Methods: We adapted an existing support program (HOPE) for PCOS using the antecedent target measure approach. We conducted qualitative interviews with 13 adult women living with PCOS, 3 trustees of a patients with PCOS advocacy charity, and 4 endocrinologists to identify "antecedents" (barriers) to self-management and psychological well-being. Framework analysis was used to identify potentially modifiable antecedents to be targeted by the novel intervention. At a national conference, 58 key stakeholders (patients and health professionals) voted for the antecedents they felt were most important to address. We used research evidence and relevant theory to design a prototype for the PCOS intervention.Results: Voting identified 32 potentially modifiable antecedents, relating to knowledge, understanding, emotions, motivation, and behaviors, as priorities to be targeted in the new intervention. A modular, web-based prototype HOPE PCOS intervention was developed to address these, covering six broad topic areas (instilling HOPE for PCOS; managing the stress of PCOS; feeding your mind and body well; body image, intimacy, and close relationships; staying healthy with PCOS; and keeping PCOS in its place).Conclusions: We identified barriers to self-management and psychological well-being in women with PCOS and used these to adapt a web-based self-management program, tailoring it for PCOS, which is a comprehensive group intervention combining education, empowerment, lifestyle management, peer support with cognitive behavioral tools, and goal-setting (to be delivered by peers or codelivered with health care professionals). The modular structure offers flexibility to adapt the program further as new clinical recommendations emerge. The intervention has the potential to be delivered, evaluated for feasibility, and, if effective, integrated into health care services. Self-management interventions are not designed to replace clinical care; rather, they serve as an additional source of support. The HOPE PCOS program conveys this message in its content

and activities. Future research should evaluate the prototype intervention using primary outcomes such as measures of psychological well-being, self-management self-efficacy, depression, anxiety, and PCOS-related quality of life. They should also assess the intervention's acceptability, scalability, and cost-effectiveness."

keywords = "anxiety, depression, PCOS, peer support, polycystic ovary syndrome, positive well-being, psychoeducation, self-management, web-based health intervention, women's health",

author = "Carol Percy and Andy Turner and Charys Orr",

note = "This is an open-access article distributed under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>), which permits unrestricted use, distribution, and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work, first published in JMIR Formative Research, is properly cited. The complete bibliographic information, a link to the original publication on <https://formative.jmir.org>, as well as this copyright and license information must be included. ",

year = "2024",

month = mar,

day = "7",

doi = "10.2196/52427",

language = "English",

volume = "2024",

journal = "JMIR Formative Research",

issn = "2561-326X",

publisher = "JMIR Publications",

number = "8",

}

TY - JOUR

T1 - Developing a Novel Web-Based Self-Management Support Intervention for Polycystic Ovary Syndrome

T2 - Mixed Methods Study With Patients and Health Care Professionals

AU - Percy, Carol

AU - Turner, Andy

AU - Orr, Charys

N1 - This is an open-access article distributed under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>), which permits unrestricted use, distribution, and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work, first published in JMIR Formative Research, is properly cited. The complete bibliographic information, a link to the original publication on <https://formative.jmir.org>, as well as this copyright and license information must be included.

PY - 2024/3/7

Y1 - 2024/3/7

N2 - Background: Polycystic ovary syndrome (PCOS) represents a significant global health burden requiring urgent attention. This common chronic endocrine and cardiometabolic condition affects around 1 in 10 women and individuals assigned female at birth, with significant adverse effects on well-being, quality of life, and mental health, as well as serious and complex long-term health consequences. International guidelines for best health care practice recommend the provision of comprehensive cognitive behavioral interventions to support self-management and improve health outcomes for those living with PCOS. Web-based health interventions have the potential to meet this need in an accessible and scalable way. **Objective:** We aim to identify barriers to self-management and psychological well-being in women with PCOS and adapt a web-based self-management program to provide a prototype digital support intervention for them. **Methods:** We adapted an existing support program (HOPE) for PCOS using the antecedent target measure approach. We conducted qualitative interviews with 13 adult women living with PCOS, 3 trustees of a patients with PCOS advocacy charity, and 4 endocrinologists to identify “antecedents” (barriers) to self-management and psychological well-being. Framework analysis was used to identify potentially modifiable antecedents to be targeted by the novel intervention. At a national conference, 58 key stakeholders (patients and health professionals) voted for the antecedents they felt were most important to address. We used research evidence and relevant theory to design a prototype for the PCOS intervention. **Results:** Voting identified 32 potentially modifiable antecedents, relating to knowledge, understanding, emotions, motivation, and behaviors, as priorities to be targeted in the new intervention. A modular, web-based prototype HOPE PCOS intervention was developed to address these, covering six broad topic areas (instilling HOPE for PCOS; managing the stress of PCOS; feeding your mind and body well; body image, intimacy, and close relationships; staying healthy with PCOS; and keeping PCOS in its place). **Conclusions:** We identified barriers to self-management and psychological well-being in women with PCOS and used these to adapt a web-based self-management program, tailoring it for PCOS, which is a comprehensive group intervention combining education, empowerment, lifestyle management, peer support with cognitive behavioral tools, and goal-setting (to be delivered by peers or codelivered with health care professionals). The modular structure offers flexibility to adapt the program further as new clinical recommendations emerge. The intervention has the potential to be delivered, evaluated for feasibility, and, if effective, integrated into health care services. Self-management interventions are not designed to replace clinical care; rather, they serve as an additional source of support. The HOPE PCOS program conveys this message in its content and activities. Future research should evaluate the prototype intervention using primary outcomes such as measures of psychological well-being, self-management self-efficacy, depression, anxiety, and PCOS-related quality of life. They should also assess the intervention’s acceptability, scalability, and cost-effectiveness.

AB - Background: Polycystic ovary syndrome (PCOS) represents a significant global health burden requiring urgent attention. This common chronic endocrine and cardiometabolic condition affects around 1 in 10 women and individuals assigned female at birth, with significant adverse effects on well-being, quality of life, and mental health, as well as serious and complex long-

term health consequences. International guidelines for best health care practice recommend the provision of comprehensive cognitive behavioral interventions to support self-management and improve health outcomes for those living with PCOS. Web-based health interventions have the potential to meet this need in an accessible and scalable way. Objective: We aim to identify barriers to self-management and psychological well-being in women with PCOS and adapt a web-based self-management program to provide a prototype digital support intervention for them. Methods: We adapted an existing support program (HOPE) for PCOS using the antecedent target measure approach. We conducted qualitative interviews with 13 adult women living with PCOS, 3 trustees of a patients with PCOS advocacy charity, and 4 endocrinologists to identify “antecedents” (barriers) to self-management and psychological well-being. Framework analysis was used to identify potentially modifiable antecedents to be targeted by the novel intervention. At a national conference, 58 key stakeholders (patients and health professionals) voted for the antecedents they felt were most important to address. We used research evidence and relevant theory to design a prototype for the PCOS intervention. Results: Voting identified 32 potentially modifiable antecedents, relating to knowledge, understanding, emotions, motivation, and behaviors, as priorities to be targeted in the new intervention. A modular, web-based prototype HOPE PCOS intervention was developed to address these, covering six broad topic areas (instilling HOPE for PCOS; managing the stress of PCOS; feeding your mind and body well; body image, intimacy, and close relationships; staying healthy with PCOS; and keeping PCOS in its place). Conclusions: We identified barriers to self-management and psychological well-being in women with PCOS and used these to adapt a web-based self-management program, tailoring it for PCOS, which is a comprehensive group intervention combining education, empowerment, lifestyle management, peer support with cognitive behavioral tools, and goal-setting (to be delivered by peers or codelivered with health care professionals). The modular structure offers flexibility to adapt the program further as new clinical recommendations emerge. The intervention has the potential to be delivered, evaluated for feasibility, and, if effective, integrated into health care services. Self-management interventions are not designed to replace clinical care; rather, they serve as an additional source of support. The HOPE PCOS program conveys this message in its content and activities. Future research should evaluate the prototype intervention using primary outcomes such as measures of psychological well-being, self-management self-efficacy, depression, anxiety, and PCOS-related quality of life. They should also assess the intervention’s acceptability, scalability, and cost-effectiveness.

KW - anxiety

KW - depression

KW - PCOS

KW - peer support

KW - polycystic ovary syndrome

KW - positive well-being

KW - psychoeducation

KW - self-management

KW - web-based health intervention

KW - women's health

U2 - 10.2196/52427

DO - 10.2196/52427

M3 - Article

SN - 2561-326X

VL - 2024

JO - JMIR Formative Research

JF - JMIR Formative Research

IS - 8

M1 - e52427

ER -



Powered by [Pure](#), [Scopus](#) & [Elsevier Fingerprint Engine™](#)

All content on this site: Copyright © 2024 [Elsevier B.V.](#) or its licensors and contributors. All rights are reserved, including those for text and data mining, AI training, and similar technologies. For all open access content, the Creative Commons licensing terms apply

We use cookies to help provide and enhance our service and tailor content. By continuing you agree to the [use of cookies](#)



[Log in to Pure](#)

[Coventry University data protection policy](#)

[About web accessibility](#)

[Report vulnerability](#)

[Contact us](#)